

HoneyPot — First-Time Setup Guide

Deception Detection Lab

Written for: a new teammate cloning this repo for the first time (Windows or macOS/Linux).

First-time setup

1. Prerequisites

- **Python 3.10+** installed and on your PATH (the setup script does *not* install Python for you). Check with `python --version`.
- **Git**. On Windows you'll also want **Git Bash** (ships with Git for Windows), since `setup.sh` is a bash script.

2. Clone the repo

```
git clone <repo-url> HoneyPot
cd HoneyPot
```

3. Run the bootstrap

- **Windows:** double-click `bootstrap.bat`, or in Git Bash run `bash setup.sh`
- **macOS:** double-click `bootstrap.command` (first run: right-click → Open to get past Gatekeeper), or run `./setup.sh`
- **Linux:** `./setup.sh`

This creates `.venv`, installs dependencies, writes `requirements.lock.txt`, and copies `.env.example` → `.env`. It is safe to re-run.

OpenCanary may fail to install on Windows/macOS — **that's expected and non-fatal**. The honeypot sensor only runs on the isolated Linux VM; on your dev machine you're just running the frontend and test harness.

4. Activate the virtual environment

- Windows (Git Bash): `source .venv/Scripts/activate`
- Windows (PowerShell): `.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1`
- macOS/Linux: `source .venv/bin/activate`

5. Fill in .env

The `.env` file is gitignored. Replace the `REPLACE_ME_*` placeholders — at minimum `OPENCANARY_LOG_PATH` and `APP_PORT`.

Verify it works

6. Run the tests

```
pytest
```

7. Generate a synthetic log

No real honeypot is needed for local dev:

```
python -m tests.harness --count 50 --decoys ssh,http,mysql --seed 1 --out sample.log
```

8. Launch the dashboards

```
python -m app.frontend --log sample.log
```

Then open `http://127.0.0.1:8000/` — Operations view at `/`, Investigation at `/investigation`.

Known gap: Flask not installed by setup.sh

`setup.sh` installs `pyyaml` `requests` `python-dotenv` `jsonschema` but **not** `flask`, even though `flask` is listed in `requirements.txt` and the frontend requires it. A fresh clone will fail at step 8 with `ModuleNotFoundError: No module named 'flask'`.

- **Quick workaround:** after step 4, run `pip install flask` (or `pip install -r requirements.txt`).
- **Proper fix:** update `setup.sh` to install from `requirements.txt` (or add `flask` to its `core-deps` line) so this works out of the box.